Practical 6: Build the RetailPulse Customer Insights Dashboard

Related topic: Build a Dashboard for Customer Insights Visualization

Objective

Assemble a dashboard combining a summary card, trend chart, segment breakdown, and a shared filter widget for RetailPulse customer data.

Materials required

IBM Cognos Analytics access and the RetailPulse Customers data module.

Step-by-step procedure

Step	Action in Cognos Analytics	What you should see
1	Click **New > Dashboard**, choose a template, then **Select a source** and pick the **RetailPulse Customers** data module.	A blank canvas opens with the data module's fields in the left panel.
2	Add a **Summary** widget: drag **Active customers** (count) onto the canvas and choose the Summary visualization.	A card shows total active customers for the selected period.
3	Add a **Line** chart: **Month** on the x-axis, **Customers** as the value, **Customer type** (New / Returning) as the series.	Two lines trend across Jan–Oct 2026.
4	Add a **Bar** chart: **Loyalty segment** on the category axis and **Customers** as the value.	Four bars: Bronze, Silver, Gold, Platinum.
5	Drag **Region** to the top of the canvas to create a **Filter** widget; select the widgets and confirm cross-filtering is on (connections).	Choosing a region re-filters the card, the line chart and the bar chart.
6	Resize and arrange widgets (filter bar on top, card and trend line next, segment bar below the card); click **Save**.	Clear visual hierarchy with no overlaps; dashboard saved in My content.

Sample solution

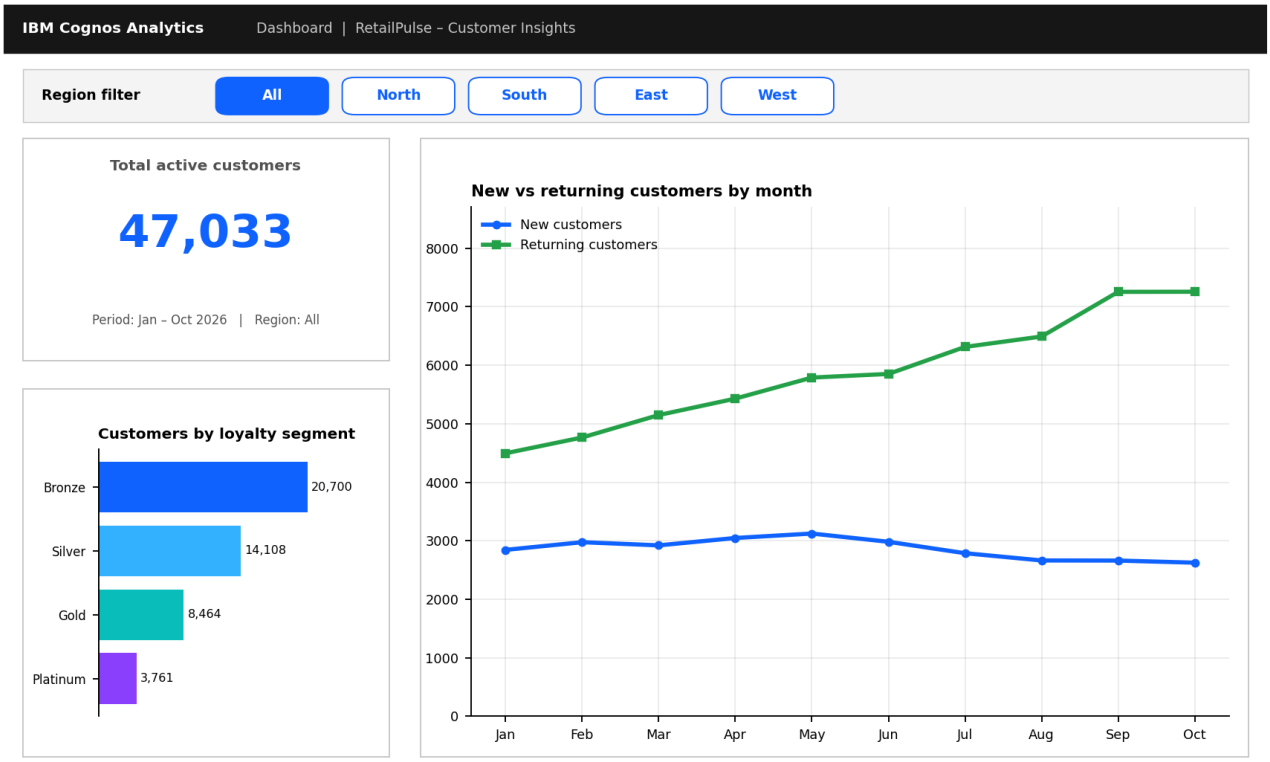


Figure 1. Dashboard with all regions selected: summary card, new-vs-returning trend line and loyalty-segment bars.

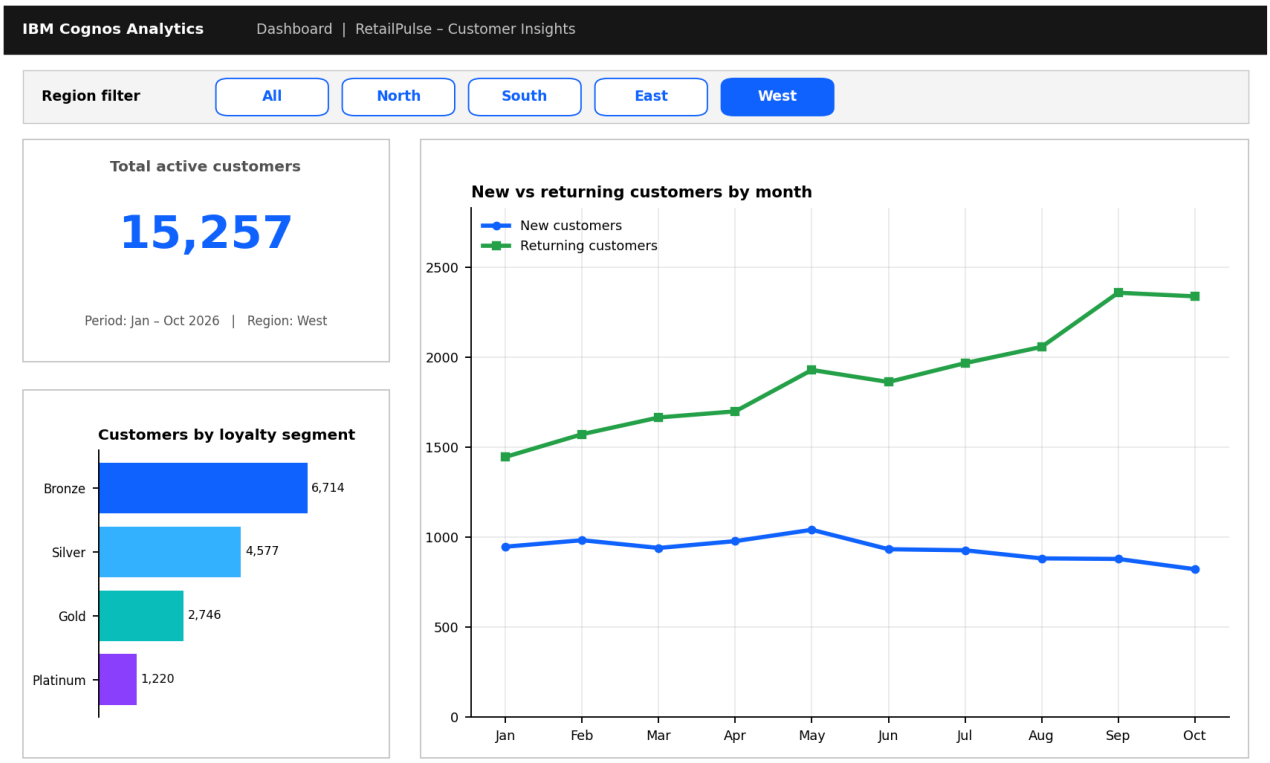


Figure 2. Region filter widget set to West – every widget updates consistently.

Cross-filter test

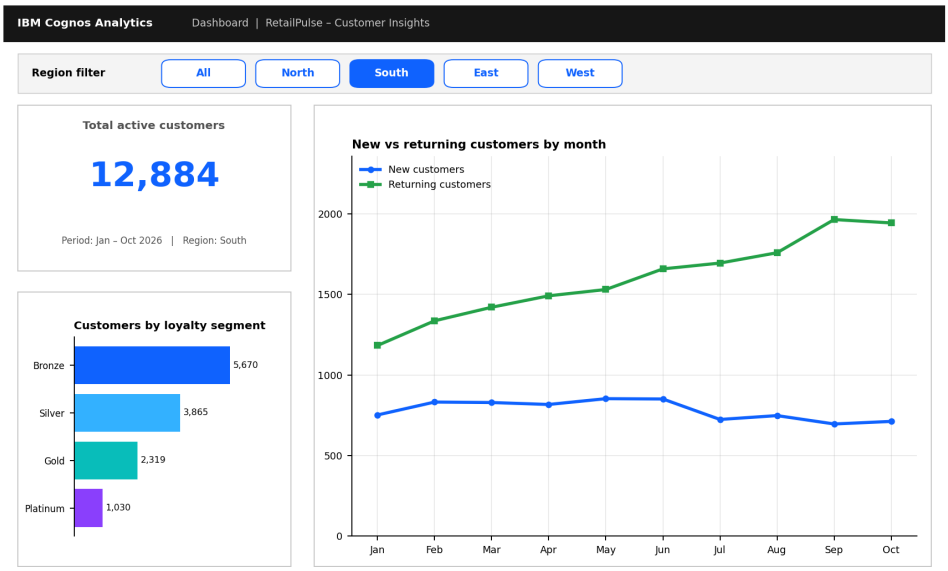


Figure 3. Region filter widget set to South.

Consistency check across widgets

Region	Total active customers	Bronze	Silver	Gold	Platinum	Segments sum to card?
North	10,326	4,545	3,097	1,858	826	Yes
South	12,884	5,670	3,865	2,319	1,030	Yes
East	8,566	3,771	2,569	1,541	685	Yes
West	15,257	6,714	4,577	2,746	1,220	Yes
All regions	47,033	20,700	14,108	8,464	3,761	Yes

The summary card equals the sum of the four loyalty-segment bars for every selection, confirming that all widgets are filtered by the same Region value.

Verification against the expected outcome

Expected outcome check	Result
All widgets display live data with no placeholder values	**Pass** – Card, line chart and bar chart populated from the Customers data module
Region filter updates every other widget consistently	**Pass** – All: 47,033; West: 15,257; South: 12,884 active customers
Trend line renders clearly across the full period	**Pass** – Jan – Oct 2026, both series visible
Clear visual hierarchy with no overlaps	**Pass** – Filter bar > summary card + trend > segment bars

Note on screens: the screenshots in this document are Cognos-style renderings produced from a synthetic RetailPulse dataset (12 stores, 4 regions, 5 product categories, 1 Jan–25 Oct 2026). Replace them with live captures from your own Cognos environment if your submission requires real screenshots.